

EBENEZER ETHIOPIAN CHURCH PORTLAND OREGON

BYLAWS

Proposed, June 2025

These bylaws shall be in compliance with, and subordinate to, ORS 065 and any applicable state and federal rules or statutes.

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Article 1: Naming and Structure

1.1 Name:

The name of this entity shall be Ebenezer Ethiopian Church Portland Oregon.

1.2 Entity:

This entity shall be registered as a religious organization. It shall file and maintain its existence with the Secretary of State of Oregon as a non-profit entity with a President, Secretary, and Treasurer as its officers, and shall be recognized by the IRS as tax-exempt under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code.

Article 2: Vision and Mission

2.1 Vision:

Our vision is to worship God in spirit and truth, continuously seeking to magnify His name. We aim to expand the love of Christ across generations, creating a legacy of faith that endures in this and the generations to come. As shepherds of God's people, we are dedicated to guiding individuals in their spiritual journeys, helping them grow in their relationship with Christ, and preparing them to inherit eternal life. We envision a community rooted in worship, empowered by the Holy Spirit, and equipped to spread the gospel of Jesus Christ in both word and deed.

2.2 Mission:

“Then Jesus came to them and said, “All authority in heaven and on earth has been given to me. Therefore go and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit”” — Matthew 28:18-19.

Our mission is to flock people into the life of faith in Jesus Christ by spreading the gospel and calling all to salvation. We are committed to bringing spiritual influence to the wider community through holistic service that addresses the spiritual, intellectual, social, and economic needs of individuals.

We seek to help our members grow in the grace that the Lord has given them, nurturing their faith and empowering them to live out the teachings of Jesus. As a church, we are dedicated to arming and awakening the next generation with the word of God, equipping them to witness the gospel, make disciples, and

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serve others. Through spiritual gatherings, meetings, Bible studies, and outreach training, we will inspire and empower individuals to live out their faith.

Under the guidance of the Holy Spirit, and within the capacity of the church, we are committed to carrying out missionary services in various places, with a focus on church planting and spreading the gospel to the ends of the earth. We aim to be a beacon of light, drawing people into the kingdom of God, and transforming lives for eternity.

Our mission includes establishing a connection between displaced persons from various countries and their resettlement in the United States. This mission is pursued through the provision of assistance with transitional processes, cultural orientation, and integration into life in the United States, including, but not limited to, job placement and language services.

Article 3: Inalienable Core Beliefs

3.1 Purpose:

The core beliefs of Ebenezer Ethiopian Church Portland Oregon are the foundational principles and values that are central, non-negotiable, and integral to the identity and purpose of this organization. These beliefs are not subject to the amendment provisions of the bylaws and may not be set aside in practice. They define our doctrine and guide our mission as a church.

3.2 Core Beliefs:

A. The Word of God:

We believe that the Bible is the inspired, infallible, and authoritative Word of God, and it serves as the foundation for all faith and practice.

B. The Holy Trinity:

We believe in the Holy Trinity—God the Father, God the Son, and God the Holy Spirit—three distinct persons in one eternal, infinite Godhead. Further, we believe in the active presence of the Holy Spirit, who empowers believers for holy living, spiritual growth, and service, and distributes spiritual gifts for the edification of the church.

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C. Mankind's Spirit, Soul, and Body:

We believe that mankind is created in the image of God. Mankind has spirit, has soul, and has body, each of which is integral to a person's identity, purpose, and relationship with God. 1 Thessalonians 5:23.

D. Speaking in Tongues:

We believe in the biblical practice of speaking in tongues as a gift of the Holy Spirit, available to believers for personal edification and for the building up of the church.

E. Divine Healing:

We believe that divine healing is part of the atonement of Jesus Christ, and that God continues to heal today, both spiritually and physically, in response to faith.

F. Salvation through Christ:

We believe that salvation is available only through faith in Jesus Christ, who died for our sins and was resurrected, offering eternal life to all who believe in Him.

G. Resurrection:

We believe in the resurrection of the dead, both the righteous and the unrighteous, with the righteous receiving eternal life and the unrighteous facing eternal separation from God.

H. The Second Coming:

We believe in the literal and imminent return of Jesus Christ to gather His Church, judge the living and the dead, and establish His eternal kingdom.

I. Baptism by Immersion:

We believe in baptism by immersion, as taught in Scripture, for the public declaration of faith and obedience to Christ's command.

J. Sanctification:

We believe in the process of sanctification, whereby believers are set apart for God's purposes and progressively transformed into the image of Christ through the work of the Holy Spirit.

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K. Communion:

We believe in the practice of Communion (the Lord's Supper) as a symbolic remembrance of Christ's sacrifice, a means of fellowship with Him and one another, and a proclamation of His death until He returns.

L. Marriage Only Between a Man and a Woman:

We believe that marriage is a Holy covenant established by God between one biological man and one biological woman, and that it serves as a reflection of Christ's relationship with the Church.

M. Child Dedication:

We believe in dedicating children to the Lord in an act of faith, seeking God's blessing and guidance as the child grows in the nurture and admonition of the Lord.

Article 4: Membership

4.1 Membership Acceptance:

Membership in Ebenezer Ethiopian Church Portland Oregon is voluntary and requires the acceptance of the church bylaws, beliefs, doctrine, and all of its faith principles by filling out a Membership Request Form. The Executive Board of Directors reserves the exclusive right to accept, deny, suspend, cancel or reinstate the membership of anyone it deems unfit with its bylaws or faith.

4.2 Eligibility for Youth Membership:

Children of existing or new members of Ebenezer Ethiopian Church Portland Oregon shall be permitted to fill out the Membership Request Form and be considered for full membership in the church at age sixteen (16) or greater. This allows the youth to formally join the church and take part in its activities, spiritual growth, and community life, in accordance with the beliefs and teachings of the church.

Article 5: The Electoral Process and Procedures

5.1 Establishment of an Election Committee:

An Election Committee shall be established to oversee the election process of all elected positions. An committee shall be formed at least one (1) calendar month

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prior to any election that is subject to these bylaws. Such committee's work shall end immediately after the announcement of the results for the election it was established.

5.2 Composition of an Election Committee:

An Election Committee shall consist of, at the minimum, three (3) members of the church who meet the following criteria:

- A. Be members in good standing of the church
- B. Be at least twenty-one (21) years of age
- C. Be elected directly by the members of the church
- D. Current office holders in any capacity, or any compensated position, shall not serve as members of an Election Committee

5.3 Removal of Election Committee Members:

If a member of an Election Committee is nominated for an elected position, becomes a declared candidate for any elected position, or assumes a compensated position, that individual shall automatically be removed from the Election Committee to maintain fairness and integrity in the election process.

5.4 Responsibilities of the Election Committee:

The Election Committee shall be responsible for ensuring the integrity of the election process. Their duties include:

- A. Overseeing the nomination process for candidates
- B. Managing the nominating, voting, counting and announcing processes
- C. Ensuring that the election process is conducted in a manner that is fair, transparent, and in accordance with established guidelines

5.5 Election Frequency:

No election shall be held within six (6) months of an election that is due pursuant to these bylaws. This ensures that elections are held in a timely and organized manner and prevents unnecessary election cycles.

5.6 Election Timing:

The election of both the Executive Board of Directors and the Elders Committee shall be held on the first (1st) Sunday of the month of April in the year in which their offices are vacated pursuant to the provisions of these bylaws.

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5.7 Assumption of Positions:

Elected members ending their terms shall arrange for an orderly transfer of their responsibilities to the newly elected members within the month of July immediately following their election. All elected members shall assume their positions at 12:00PM on the 1st day of the month of August following their election. This ensures a smooth transition and continuity of leadership within the church.

5.8 Vacancy Filling:

In the event that an elected member vacates their office voluntarily or involuntarily, such positions shall be filled in accordance with the vacancy filling procedures outlined in these bylaws.

5.9 Eligibility to Assume a Position:

To be eligible to assume a position on either the Executive Board of Directors or the Elders Committee, a member of the church must meet the following criteria:

- A. Be a member of the church in good standing for a minimum of one (1) year.
- B. Be at least twenty-one (21) years of age or older by the date of election.

5.10 Eligibility to Vote:

To be eligible to vote in any election held by the church, a member shall meet the following criteria:

- A. Be a member of the church in good standing
- B. Be a recorded member of the church for a minimum of six (6) months

Article 6: Leadership Structure

6.1 The Executive Board of Directors:

For legal, structural, formation, and administrative purposes, the organization shall be administered by a body of Executive Board of Directors.

6.2 Composition of the Executive Board of Directors:

The Executive Board of Directors shall consist of five (5) members who are directly elected by members of the church. Among them shall be a President, a Treasurer, a Secretary, and two (2) at-large members.

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6.3 Roles of members the Executive Board of Directors:

A. President:

The President shall preside over all meetings of the Executive Board of Directors, represent the organization in official capacities, and oversee the general organizational operation of the church. The office of the president is elected for a period of five (5) years, with a maximum of three (3) consecutive or non-consecutive terms.

B. Treasurer:

The duties of the Treasurer shall include, but are not limited to:

- i. Responsible for the financial affairs of the organization
- ii. Develops and proposes an annual budget to the Executive Board of Directors
- iii. Responsible for accurate accounting and financial reporting by using software or subscription services of an acceptable accounting means
- iv. The treasurer shall develop, and upon approval of the Executive Board of Directors, make practical a financial procedure manual or an equivalent set of policies that outline the collection and accounting of money from sources within and out of the church, and the depositing of such money in the designated bank accounts owned by the church.
- v. Accounts for and tracks inventory of the assets of the church.
- vi. Issues and transmits tax documents to members of the church, government entities, employees, and donors, to include payroll, 1099s, and W-2s as frequently as appropriate.

C. Secretary:

The duties of the Secretary shall include, but are not limited to:

- i. Maintain accurate records of all board meetings, agenda, and minutes. Records of board meetings shall include the date, time, and location of the meeting, names and titles of board members present and absent, status of quorum, corrections and amendments to previous meeting minutes, agendas, and votes on agendas.
- ii. Maintains official documents of the organization.
- iii. Maintains an accurate roster and tally of members of the church
- iv. Timely establishes or renews and properly stores licenses, registrations, credentials and insurance, that is required for the legal operation and continuation of the church.

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D. At-large Members:

- i. At-large members of the Executive Board of Directors serve in the governance and strategic direction of the church, represent the interests of the entire congregation, providing a balanced and unbiased perspective in decision-making processes. They shall be responsible for offering input on policies, programs, missions and initiatives, ensuring that all actions align with the church's teachings, beliefs and principles. They shall work closely with church leadership of all levels to provide oversight, maintain accountability, and support the overall health and growth of the church.
- ii. At-large members of the Executive Board of Directors may be designated to serve in any capacity within the Executive Board of Directors.

6.4 Term Limits:

As it relates to both members of the Executive Board of Directors and Elders Committee, unless specified otherwise within these bylaws, each member shall serve a term of three (3) years, with a maximum of three (3) consecutive or non-consecutive terms.

6.5 Quorum:

The quorum for all board and committee meetings shall be 60% of the members.

6.6 Committee Formation:

The Executive Board of Directors may form or assemble groups or committees for any legitimate reason it deems necessary to assist it with the governance and furtherance of the organization.

Article 7: The Elders Committee

7.1 Composition of the Elders Committee:

The Elders Committee shall consist of the following:

- A. Four (4) members who are directly elected by the members of the church
- B. The pastoral office, which shall be an ex officio permanent member of the Elders Committee with one (1) voting power

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7.2 Officers of the Elders Committee:

- A. The pastoral office shall be the Chair of the Elders Committee
- B. Within fourteen (14) calendar days after its assumption of office, at its first meeting, the Elders Committee shall elect its Vice-Chair, Treasurer, and Secretary from the members who are directly elected by members of the church
- C. The election of officers pursuant to this section shall be reported to the Executive Board of Directors immediately thereafter

7.3 Duties of the Elders Committee:

The duties of the Elders Committee are, primarily, to provide spiritual leadership and counsel to the congregation. Members of the Elders Committee shall adhere to, uphold and rely on these bylaws, beliefs and the doctrine of the Ebenezer Ethiopian Church Portland Oregon in carrying out their duties and responsibilities. The duties of the Elders Committee include:

- A. Acting as mediators between members of the church
- B. Delivering sermons and instructing, upon assignment by the pastor
- C. Supervising the spiritual well-being of the church
- D. Providing assistance and guidance to the pastoral office
- E. Evaluating, making corrections, approving or denying the delivery of teachings to the congregation
- F. Ensuring the appropriate expenditure of allocated budget and reporting to the Executive Board of Directors

7.4 Deacons' Assignment:

The Elders Committee shall be responsible for the appointment and maintaining a number of Deacons on assignment that it deems adequate for the effective and faithful execution of the functions of the church.

Article 8: Frequency of Leadership Meetings

8.1 Meetings of the Executive Board of Directors:

- A. The first Executive Board of Directors shall hold a working meeting at least once per calendar month during the first twelve (12) months after the adoption of these bylaws

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- B. After the first year, the first Executive Board of Directors shall meet no less than once every two calendar months for the rest of its term
- C. Future Executive Board of Directors shall meet no less than once per calendar quarter
- D. Additional meetings may be called as necessary to address urgent matters or issues requiring immediate attention

8.2 Meetings of the Elders Committee:

- A. Meetings of the committee may be called either by the Chair or the Vice-Chair of the committee or their designees
- B. All meetings shall be chaired by the Chair or the Vice-Chair of the committee or their designees
- C. Agenda for committee meetings shall be shared with all members of the committee as far in advance as practically possible prior to the meetings

Article 9: Budgetary Procedures

9.1 Fiscal Year:

The fiscal year of Ebenezer Ethiopian Church Portland Oregon shall follow the calendar year, beginning on January 1st and ending on December 31st.

9.2 Budget Proposal:

The Elders Committee shall prepare and present a nonbinding proposed budget for the upcoming fiscal year to the Executive Board of Directors no later than October 1st. This proposed budget shall include estimates of income and expenses required to support the church's activities, operations, and ministries.

9.3 Budget Approval:

The Executive Board of Directors shall review and make corrections, if necessary, to the proposed budget and provide an approved budget no later than December 15th. The approved budget shall reflect the priorities and financial commitments necessary for the church's continued growth and operations throughout the upcoming fiscal year.

Article 10: Handling of Accounts and Expenditure

10.1 Supervision of Bank Accounts:

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- A. All bank accounts of Ebenezer Ethiopian Church Portland Oregon shall be under the direct supervision of the Treasurer's office of the Executive Board of Directors.
- B. No bank account shall be established in the name of the church without the prior consent of the Executive Board of Directors.
- C. No monetary activity, including the establishment or management of savings, checking, or electronic accounts, shall be conducted in the personal name of any individual or group of individuals on behalf of the church without prior authorization.

10.2 Authorization of Specific Accounts:

- A. The Executive Board of Directors, by resolution, may designate the Treasurer of the Elders Committee to handle specific accounts that are established for the expenditure of an allocated budget.
- B. Such accounts shall be managed in accordance with the policies and procedures set forth by the Executive Board of Directors.

10.3 Expenditure Authorization:

Any expenditure, including those from an already allocated budget, in a single transaction in excess of \$5,000 from any church account shall require authorization and signatures from both the Treasurer and the President of the Executive Board of Directors.

10.4 Authorized Signatories:

Upon the assumption of office by new members, the names of the Treasurer and the President of the Executive Board of Directors shall be updated with the applicable financial institutions within ten (10) business days.

10.5 Financial Record Keeping:

- A. The Treasurer of the Executive Board of Directors, in coordination with the Treasurer of the Elders Committee and applicable accounting staff, shall maintain accurate financial records of all accounts of the church, which shall be available for review by any member of the church.
- B. The Treasurer of the board shall present a financial status update to the Executive Board of Directors at least once per calendar quarter.

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10.6 Annual Financial Report:

- A. The Treasurer of the Executive Board of Directors shall present an annual financial report to the General Assembly of Members.
- B. The report shall be presented in written format or delivered as a live presentation.
- C. This report shall be presented no later than the last Sunday of the month of January following the close of the fiscal year.

Article 11: Indemnification of Members Elected

11.1 Indemnification

By virtue of their election, Ebenezer Ethiopian Church Portland Oregon indemnifies its Executive Board of Directors to protect them from financial harm and liabilities arising from execution of their leadership roles.

Article 12: Removal of Members of the Leadership

12.1 Removal by the Board

Elected members of the Executive Board of Directors and the Elders Committee may be removed for cause by a majority vote of the existing Executive Board of Directors. Elected members may also resign by mutual decision or due to lack of time, health issues, or other amicable reasons.

12.2 Removal by Members of the Church

Notwithstanding other provisions within these bylaws, members of the church may propose the removal of any member of either the Executive Board of Directors or Elders Committee without cause, by collecting, at the minimum, the signatures of fifty-one percent (51%) of members of the church in good standing at the time of the signature collection, each of whom must have been a member for at least one (1) year or greater and has reached the age of 21.

Article 13: Vacancy Filling

13.1 Filling by Affirmative Vote

If elected members remaining in positions constitute fewer than the required quorum, they may fill the vacancy created by the affirmative vote of the majority of the elected members remaining in office.

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13.2 Declaration of Vacancy

The Secretary of the Executive Board of Directors shall declare the vacancy within one (1) month of the creation of the vacancy to members of the church.

13.3 Filling by Members' Vote

The vacancy shall be filled by the majority vote of members present at a designated meeting of the members within less than sixty (60) days of the creation of the vacancy, unless otherwise provided within these bylaws.

Article 14: The Pastoral Office

14.1 Pastor:

Ebenezer Ethiopian Church Portland Oregon may hire a full-time Pastor within the Pastoral Office, who reports directly to the Executive Board of Directors. The Pastor shall be responsible for the overall spiritual leadership and pastoral care of the congregation.

14.2 Additional Pastors:

The Executive Board of Directors may, at its discretion, hire or assign additional pastors to support in fulfilling the pastoral needs of the church.

14.3 Pastoral Duties:

- A. **Leadership and Worship:** Pastors may lead worship services, deliver sermons, and oversee various church ceremonies such as baptisms, dedications, weddings, and funerals.
- B. **Spiritual Leadership:** Pastors assist the congregation on their spiritual journey by providing guidance and direction.
- C. **Discipleship and Mentoring:** Pastors encourage spiritual growth and maturity among church members through personal mentoring, discipleship programs, and small group leadership.
- D. **Preaching and Teaching:** Pastors regularly deliver sermons and teachings based on the Bible, the principles and faith beliefs of this church to educate and inspire church members.
- E. **Mission and Evangelism:** Pastors lead and organize efforts for local and global missions, evangelistic outreach, and community service.

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- F. Pastoral Care: Pastors offer support, counseling, and guidance to individuals within the congregation during times of need, such as illness, grief, or personal crises.
- G. Prayer: Pastors engage in and lead prayer for the congregation, the community, and global issues.
- H. Community Engagement: Pastors represent the church in the broader community and participate in community events, services, and outreach.
- I. Operational Administration: Pastors oversee the operational aspects of the church, including paid and unpaid staff management and the overall management of the church affairs.
- J. Pastors shall be licensed wedding officiants by the State of Oregon and/or any other applicable governing body.

Article 15: Removal and Disciplinary Action for Pastors

15.1 Circumstances for Removal or Disciplinary Action:

Pastors may be subject to removal or disciplinary action under the following circumstances:

- A. Resignation:
A pastor may voluntarily resign from their position by submitting a written resignation to the Executive Board of Directors.
- B. Violations of the Bylaws:
A pastor may be removed or disciplined if they violate the bylaws of Ebenezer Ethiopian Church Portland Oregon, including but not limited to failure to adhere to the organizational guidelines, policies, and procedures.
- C. Teachings Against the Church's Beliefs, Principles, and Doctrine:
A pastor may be subject to disciplinary action if they teach or promote beliefs that are in direct contradiction to the core beliefs, principles, and doctrine of Ebenezer Ethiopian Church Portland Oregon as outlined in the bylaws. This includes, but is not limited to, heretical teachings, divisive behavior, or preaching that undermines the foundational tenets of the church.
- D. Immoral or Unethical Conduct:
A pastor may be removed or disciplined if involved in immoral or unethical conduct that discredits the church, harms the congregation, or goes against biblical standards of conduct.

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E. Failure to Fulfill Pastoral Responsibilities:

If a pastor consistently fails to fulfill their pastoral duties, including leading worship services, offering spiritual guidance, and overseeing the spiritual well-being of the congregation, disciplinary action may be necessary

F. Criminal Behavior or Legal Issues:

Any criminal behavior, legal disputes, or actions that bring disrepute to the church, its leadership, or the community may lead to removal or disciplinary action.

G. Conflict of Interest or Misuse of Church Resources:

A pastor who uses their position for personal gain, engages in conflicts of interest, or misuses church resources may face removal or disciplinary action.

15.2 Process for Removal or Disciplinary Action:

A. Investigation:

When an issue arises that may warrant the removal or disciplinary action of a pastor, the Executive Board of Directors will initiate an investigation to determine the facts. This may involve gathering testimony from witnesses, reviewing relevant materials, and providing the pastor with an opportunity to explain their actions.

B. Investigative Team:

For the purpose of investigating an allegation against pastoral staff, an investigative team shall be established. The investigative team shall be composed of two (2) members of the Executive Board of Directors, two (2) members of the Elders Committee and one (1) member of the General Assembly of Members. An investigative team shall deliver its findings to the Executive Board of Directors no later than thirty (30) business days.

C. Decision:

After the investigation, the Executive Board of Directors will make a decision regarding the pastor's status. If removal or disciplinary action is deemed necessary, a vote will be conducted by the Executive Board of Directors. The decision rendered by the Executive Board of Directors is final.

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15.3 Types of Disciplinary Action:

Disciplinary action may include, but is not limited to:

A. Verbal or Written Reprimand:

A formal statement of concern or correction issued to the pastor.

B. Suspension:

Temporary removal from certain duties or responsibilities within the church.

C. Probation:

A period of evaluation during which the pastor must demonstrate a commitment to improving behavior or performance.

D. Removal from Office:

Permanent removal from the pastoral position, which may include termination of employment or revocation of ministerial authority.

Article 16: Emeritus Status

16.1 Qualification:

Emeritus status may be conferred upon past or present members of the church who have demonstrated exceptional dedication and service to the church and its missions, beliefs and principles. Qualification for elevation to this status requires a minimum of ten (10) years of membership of the church in good standing. Titles may include Pastor Emeritus, Deacon Emeritus, Elder Emeritus, or other titles adopted by unanimous consent of the Executive Board of Directors. Final authorization for elevation to Emeritus status requires 80% vote of the Executive Board of Directors.

Article 17: Hiring Staff

17.1 Hiring Process:

The Executive Board of Directors has exclusive power to hire, suspend, reinstate, or terminate any employee of the organization, including pastors and other personnel, pursuant to the standards of the entity. The hiring process shall include a submitted application for employment, interviewing candidates, and conducting a nationwide criminal background check. Successful hiring requires the consent of 80% of the Executive Board of Directors.

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17.2 Search Committee:

For the purpose of searching and identifying prospective candidates for pastoral staff positions, the Executive Board of Directors shall establish a search committee composed of no more than five (5) individuals. The committee shall include members from both the Executive Board of Directors and the Elders Committee. The search committee will be responsible for evaluating candidates and making a nonbinding recommendation to the Executive Board of Directors regarding the candidates it evaluated.

17.3 Compensation:

Compensated employees of the church are non-voting members of the church, unless otherwise permitted elsewhere within these bylaws. Compensation shall be established by the Executive Board of Directors.

17.4 Recusal:

If a member of the Executive Board of Directors assumes a compensated position within the Church, that individual shall recuse themselves from any and all decisions, discussions or deliberations related to their position, hiring process, or compensation. The conflict of interest, or an appearance of it shall be avoided by the rest of the leadership structure.

Article 18: Service/Ministry Departments

18.1 Establishment of Service/Ministry Departments:

The Elders Committee may establish various service or ministry departments as it sees fit to support the mission and activities of Ebenezer Ethiopian Church Portland Oregon.

18.2 Accountability:

Service departments or ministries, through their respective leaders, are accountable to the pastoral office or their designees. These departments and their leaders are responsible for fulfilling their assigned functions in accordance with the vision and direction of the church.

18.3 Chain of Service Departments:

The Elders Committee shall maintain a current list of service departments or ministries, including the names of their respective leaders and contact information.

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Article 19: Record Keeping and Retention

19.1 Storage and Maintenance:

Financial books and all documentary records, including board meeting minutes shall be kept in the church offices or in secured electronic means. The location and accessibility of these records shall be agreed upon by the Executive Board of Directors.

Article 20: Amendments to the Bylaws

20.1 Amendments:

- A. Amendments to the bylaws of the church may be proposed by any member of the church with a recorded membership of a minimum of six (6) months.
- B. Amendments require a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the Executive Board of Directors for presentation and consideration by members of the church.
- C. If the necessary votes are attained, within twelve (12) months, the Secretary shall notify members of the church of the proposed amendments and shall provide a minimum of four (4) Sundays before members of the church can hold a vote for adoption.
- D. A proposed amendment shall be adopted by two-thirds (2/3) vote of members present.

Article 21: General Assembly of Members

21.1 Frequency of Meetings:

The General Assembly of Members shall meet, at the minimum, one (1) time per calendar year to discuss matters of importance to the church and its members.

21.2 Calling of Meetings:

The General Assembly of Members may be called at any time necessary by the President of the Executive Board of Directors or their designee to address urgent matters, provide updates, or facilitate discussions related to the church's activities and direction.

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Article 22: Alliances and Subordination

22.1 Alliance Making:

The Executive Board of Directors may make alliances or enter into contractual agreement that would bring value to this organization with other organizations, community groups, governmental entities and the like; such relationships shall be in compliance with the church's teachings, beliefs and principles. The Executive Board of Directors as a whole shall be the council to enter into, administer, execute, or exit from alliance and contractual relations.

22.2 Subordination:

These bylaws are subordinate to state and federal rules, regulations and statutes. In an event when an alliance with another organization is created pursuant to Article 22, these bylaws shall be subordinate to the bylaws of the organization with which the alliance is made to facilitate the smooth execution of it.

- END -

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ORGANIZATIONAL CHART

